

Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

EMPLOYEE HR POLICY HANDBOOK | Version 1.0 | Effective 1 April 2026 | Fictional document for RAG testing

1. Purpose and Scope

This handbook defines the core people policies of Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. It applies to all regular full-time employees in India unless a contract, local law, or written HR exception states otherwise. Interns, consultants, and contractors are covered only where a section explicitly says so.

Policy owner: People & Culture (HR) | **Approver:** Chief People Officer | **Review cycle:** Annual, every March.

2. Employment Categories

Category	Typical status	Policy coverage
Regular full-time	Permanent employee after confirmation	All standard benefits and leave provisions
Probationary	First 6 months unless extended	Most policies apply; some benefits activate after confirmation
Fixed-term	Employed for a defined contract period	Benefits as specified in offer letter and law
Intern / Trainee	Learning assignment	Stipend and leave as stated in engagement letter
Contractor	Third-party or independent professional	Not treated as an employee unless specifically stated

3. Working Hours and Attendance

- Normal workweek: Monday to Friday, 40 hours per week. Standard hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM with a 1-hour meal break.
- Employees may use the flexible arrival window of 8:30 AM to 10:30 AM, provided they complete required hours and attend scheduled collaboration meetings.
- Attendance must be recorded in the HR portal by the employee. Missing entries should be corrected within 3 working days.
- An employee who expects to be absent or more than 60 minutes late must inform the reporting manager as early as practical, normally before 10:00 AM.
- Three or more consecutive working days of unexplained absence may trigger an HR welfare check and formal attendance review.

4. Probation and Confirmation

The standard probation period is 6 months. The manager conducts a confirmation review during the fifth month. Probation may be extended once, for up to 3 additional months, when performance or role-readiness needs more observation. Confirmation, extension, or separation is communicated in writing by HR.

Quick RAG facts: Standard workweek = 40 hours; standard probation = 6 months; maximum normal probation extension = 3 months; attendance corrections = within 3 working days.

Leave and Time-Off Policy

Page 2 of 5 | All leave must be requested through the HR portal unless an emergency prevents it

5. Annual Leave Entitlements

Leave type	Annual entitlement	Carry forward / expiry	Approval guidance
Privilege Leave (PL)	18 working days	Carry forward up to 30 days	Request 5 working days in advance when leave is 3+ days
Casual Leave (CL)	6 working days	No carry forward; expires 31 Dec	Normally request at least 1 working day in advance
Sick Leave (SL)	8 working days	No carry forward	Inform manager promptly; certificate may be requested for 3+ co
Birthday Leave	1 working day	No carry forward	Use during birthday month
Bereavement Leave	Up to 5 working days per event	Not applicable	Immediate family; HR may approve exceptions

6. Leave Administration Rules

- Leave is counted only on scheduled working days. Weekends and declared company holidays falling inside approved leave are not deducted from the leave balance.
- Negative leave balances are not normally allowed. HR may approve up to 3 days of advance PL in exceptional cases.
- Unused PL above the 30-day carry-forward cap lapses at year-end unless local law requires otherwise.
- During notice period, planned leave requires manager and HR approval. Leave cannot automatically be used to shorten the notice period.
- Employees should not perform regular work while on approved leave, except for a genuine emergency and with manager agreement.

7. Parental and Special Leave

Policy	Entitlement / rule
Maternity leave	As required by applicable Indian law; eligible employees may receive up to 26 weeks subject to statutory conditions.
Paternity / Partner leave	10 working days, to be used within 90 days of birth or adoption placement.
Adoption leave	Eligible employees may receive leave as required by applicable law and company policy; contact HR for case-specific eligi
Marriage leave	3 working days, once during employment, to be taken within 30 days of the registered marriage date.
Compensatory off	1 day for approved work on a declared company holiday or weekly off; must normally be used within 60 days.

8. Sick Leave and Medical Evidence

A medical certificate may be requested when sick leave lasts 3 or more consecutive working days, when absence patterns are recurring, or when required for workplace safety. Medical information will be handled confidentially and access will be limited to people with a legitimate business need.

Quick RAG facts: PL = 18 days; CL = 6 days; SL = 8 days; PL carry-forward cap = 30 days; partner leave = 10 working days; comp-off validity = 60 days.

Hybrid Work, Travel and Expense Policy

Page 3 of 5 | Business requirements and client commitments may override normal hybrid schedules

9. Hybrid and Remote Work

- Default hybrid schedule for eligible roles: minimum 3 days per week from the assigned office or approved client location.
- Tuesday and Thursday are anchor collaboration days for corporate teams unless the function publishes a different schedule.
- Up to 20 working days of temporary work-from-anywhere within India may be approved per calendar year. Requests require manager approval at least 10 working days in advance.
- Working from another country is not permitted without prior written approval from HR, Legal, Tax, Information Security, and the business head.
- Employees must use company-managed devices, approved VPN/security controls, and must not leave confidential information visible in public areas.

10. Home Office and Connectivity

Eligible regular employees may claim up to INR 1,500 per month toward home internet expenses with a valid bill. The company may provide standard peripherals based on role requirements. Furniture purchases require prior approval and are not automatically reimbursable.

11. Business Travel

Item	Standard policy
Air travel	Economy class for flights under 6 hours. Premium economy may be approved for flights of 6 hours or more.
Rail travel	AC Chair Car or AC 2-Tier, based on route and business need.
Hotel cap - Tier 1 cities	Up to INR 8,000 per night before taxes unless an approved corporate rate applies.
Hotel cap - Other cities	Up to INR 5,500 per night before taxes.
Local transport	Reasonable taxi / app-cab costs for business travel are reimbursable with receipt.
Meals	Actuals up to INR 1,500 per day for domestic overnight travel; alcohol is not reimbursable.

12. Expense Reimbursement

- Expense reports should be submitted within 15 calendar days after the expense or trip ends.
- Original or digital receipts are required for individual expenses above INR 500.
- Employees must use the corporate travel portal where available. Out-of-policy bookings need written approval from the cost-center owner.
- Finance targets reimbursement within 10 working days after a complete and approved claim is received.

Quick RAG facts: Minimum office presence = 3 days/week; India work-from-anywhere allowance = 20 working days/year; internet reimbursement = INR 1,500/month; expense submission = 15 calendar days.

Conduct, Information Security and Workplace Standards

Page 4 of 5 | Employees are responsible for following both HR and Information Security requirements

13. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to act lawfully, respectfully, and in the best interests of the company while protecting customers, colleagues, assets, and confidential information. Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith is prohibited.

14. Respectful Workplace and Harassment

- Discrimination, bullying, harassment, sexual harassment, threats, and retaliation are prohibited in offices, online meetings, work chats, travel, client sites, and company events.
- Concerns may be raised with the manager, HR Business Partner, Ethics Helpline, or Internal Committee where applicable.
- Reports are reviewed promptly and as confidentially as practical. Employees must cooperate honestly with investigations.

15. Confidentiality and Data Handling

Classification	Examples	Handling rule
Public	Published website content, approved press releases	May be shared externally after normal review
Internal	Internal procedures, general team documents	Share only with employees/authorized parties who need it
Confidential	Customer data, contracts, source code, employee data	Use approved systems; no personal email or consumer storage
Restricted	Passwords, private keys, regulated sensitive data	Strict need-to-know; encryption and approved vaults required

16. Acceptable Use and Generative AI

- Company devices and accounts are primarily for authorized business use. Limited personal use is allowed when lawful, reasonable, and does not interfere with work or security.
- Employees must not paste Confidential or Restricted information into public generative AI services unless the service is explicitly approved for that data classification.
- AI-generated work must be reviewed by a responsible employee before it is used for business decisions, customer delivery, code deployment, legal communication, or public publication.
- Suspected phishing, credential exposure, or loss of a company device must be reported to the Service Desk or Security team immediately.

17. Conflict of Interest and Gifts

Employees must disclose actual or potential conflicts of interest. Gifts or hospitality from a single external party should not exceed INR 5,000 in value without written approval from the Ethics Officer. Cash or cash-equivalent gifts are never acceptable.

Quick RAG facts: Gift threshold without additional approval = INR 5,000; public AI tools must not receive Confidential or Restricted company information unless specifically approved.

Performance, Benefits, Grievance and Separation

Page 5 of 5 | Final page - fictional policy document for retrieval and question-answer testing

18. Performance and Learning

- Formal performance check-ins occur twice each year: a mid-year review in July and a year-end review in January.
- Employees and managers should maintain clear goals, evidence of outcomes, and development actions throughout the year.
- Eligible regular employees may claim up to INR 25,000 per financial year for pre-approved job-related learning, certifications, or professional development.

19. Health and Wellbeing Benefits

- Group medical insurance is provided to eligible employees according to the annual benefits schedule. Dependent coverage and premium sharing may vary by plan year.
- Employees have access to a confidential Employee Assistance Program (EAP) for counseling and wellbeing support.
- Annual preventive health checks may be offered to eligible employees based on age band and insurer program.

20. Grievance and Escalation Process

Stage	Route	Target response
1	Discuss with reporting manager where appropriate	Within 3 working days
2	Raise with HR Business Partner	Acknowledgement within 2 working days
3	Escalate to Head of HR / Ethics channel for unresolved or sensitive matters	Case-specific; status updates at least every 10 working days

21. Resignation and Notice Period

- Standard notice period after confirmation: 60 calendar days unless the employment letter specifies otherwise.
- During probation, the standard notice period is 15 calendar days unless the employment letter specifies otherwise.
- Early release may be approved based on business handover, accrued leave, client obligations, and applicable recovery or notice-pay terms.
- Company assets, credentials, documents, and confidential information must be returned or transferred before the last working day.

22. Final Settlement and Exit

HR coordinates exit clearance with the employee, manager, IT, Finance, and Administration. Subject to completion of clearance and applicable payroll requirements, the company targets full-and-final settlement within 30 calendar days from the last working day. Statutory timelines prevail where different.

23. Policy Exceptions and Interpretation

This handbook is a general policy guide and does not override applicable law or an individual employment agreement. HR may clarify interpretation and approve documented exceptions with appropriate business authorization. The company may revise policies with reasonable communication to employees.

RAG test questions you can try: How many PL days are allowed? What is the PL carry-forward cap? How many days can I work from anywhere in India? What is the hotel cap in a Tier 1 city? Can I paste customer data into public GenAI? What is the notice period after confirmation? How soon should final settlement be completed?